

F5 Daily Briefing — Monday, May 11, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

16

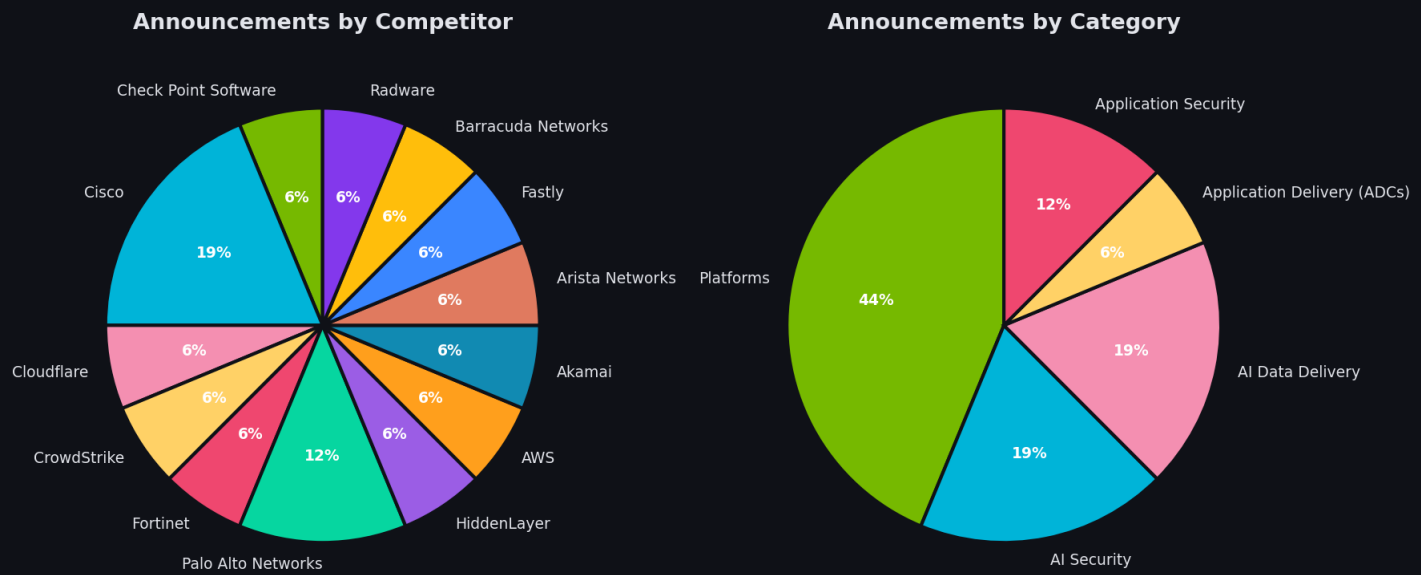
ANNOUNCEMENTS

13

ACTIVE

5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (16)

CORPORATE

Check Point Software

2026-05-11

Check Point Announces \$2.0 Billion Expansion of Share Repurchase Authorization

Check Point Software Technologies announced on May 11, 2026 a \$2.0 billion expansion of its share repurchase authorization. The board approved extending the current program, with purchases to be executed via open-market or privately negotiated transactions, potentially under a 10b5-1 plan, funded from available working capital. As of March 31, 2026, Check Point had approximately 104 million ordinary shares outstanding and had cumulatively repurchased about 230 million shares for roughly \$17.4 billion since the program began. The announcement was accompanied by reaffirmation of the company's AI-powered Infinity Platform serving 100,000+ organizations across Harmony, CloudGuard, Quantum, and Infinity Core Services.

Source: <https://www.checkpoint.com/press-releases/check-point-software-technologies-announces-2-0-billion-expansion-of-share-repurchase-authorization-2/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-05-11

Cisco Unveils AI-Native Networking Platform at Cisco Live 2026

At Cisco Live 2026 in Las Vegas, Cisco unveiled an AI-native networking platform that embeds an upgraded Cisco AI Network Assistant directly into enterprise switching, routing, and wireless infrastructure, with LLMs fine-tuned on network telemetry. Capabilities include Autonomous Root Cause Analysis resolving up to ~85% of common anomalies without human intervention, Natural Language Configuration of VLANs and routing policies, Predictive Capacity Planning up to 72 hours via Catalyst Center, and Zero-Trust AI Enforcement with dynamic segmentation. Cross-Domain Correlation across switching, wireless, SD-WAN, and security claims ~60% MTTR reduction, intensifying competition with Juniper/Mist and Aruba/HPE.

Source: <https://cciedump.spoto.net/news/cisco-unveils-ai-native-networking-platform-at-cisco-live-2026-what-it-pros-need-to-know.html>

CORPORATE**Cloudflare**

2026-05-11

Cloudflare Cuts 1,100 Jobs (~20% of Workforce) in AI-Driven Restructuring

Cloudflare announced on May 11, 2026 it will lay off about 1,100 employees—roughly 20% of its workforce—as it restructures around AI-enabled workflows for an 'agentic AI era.' Executives framed the cuts as a strategic realignment, not performance or cost reductions, citing a more-than-600% increase in internal AI tool usage across departments. The company expects \$140-\$150M in Q2 charges, will provide severance through year-end, US healthcare through December 31, and accelerated equity vesting. Cloudflare beat Q1 revenue and earnings expectations with \$639.8M (+34% YoY), though shares dropped over 20% on softer near-term guidance.

Source: <https://www.securityweek.com/cloudflare-lays-off-1100-employees-in-ai-driven-restructuring/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**CrowdStrike**

2026-05-11

CrowdStrike Launches Jet Mobile App and Expands AI Alliances Under Project QuiltWorks

CrowdStrike announced two major updates on May 11, 2026: the launch of Jet, a unified mobile app for partners that handles deal registration in under 30 seconds, sales tracking, enablement, and instant cash rewards via CrowdCard loaded to Apple Wallet or Google Wallet; and an expansion of Project QuiltWorks with new AI alliances including Anthropic, OpenAI, Armadin, Cognizant, HCLTech, Infosys, KPMG, NTT DATA, TCS, and Wipro. The alliance integrates leading AI models with the Falcon platform, accelerates partner-led deployments, and reinforces CrowdStrike's AI-driven security ecosystem, aiming to broaden adoption across large enterprises standardizing on Falcon for AI risk practices.

Source: <https://completeaitraining.com/news/crowdstrike-launches-jet-partner-app-and-expands-ai/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Fortinet**

2026-05-11

Fortinet Advances Security Operations Platform with Unified SOC, Agentic AI, and Expanded Endpoint Security

At Fortinet Accelerate 2026 on May 11, Fortinet announced major Security Operations Platform updates: a unified, AI-powered SecOps platform across self-managed, cloud, and managed deployments. The new FortiSOC is a cloud-delivered service combining FortiAnalyzer, FortiSIEM, FortiSOAR, and FortiTIP under one console, with enhanced telemetry, analytics, case management, identity investigations, agentic AI workflows, and scalable licensing. FortiAI agentic workflows are now integrated across the SecOps stack to automate alert triage, threat hunting, and response while preserving context via Model Context Protocol. FortiGuard SOC-as-a-Service gains broader third-party log sources, and FortiEndpoint receives enhancements within the unified architecture.

Source: <https://www.fortinet.com/corporate/about-us/newsroom/press-releases/2026/fortinet-advances-its-security-operations-platform-with-unified-soc-agentic-ai-and-expanded-endpoint-security>

PARTNERSHIP**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-11

Palo Alto Networks Signs Strategic MoU with UAE Cyber Security Council

Palo Alto Networks and the UAE Cyber Security Council signed a strategic MoU on May 11, 2026, to build an AI-driven, data-centric cybersecurity ecosystem in the UAE. The collaboration establishes a Cybersecurity Centre of Excellence for capacity building, environmental simulation, and joint technology demonstrations. It also enhances national incident response visibility for the UAE CERT, develops national cyber talent, and addresses AI governance, post-quantum cryptography, smart city security, and joint research opportunities. Executives from both organizations emphasized strengthening the UAE's digital resilience, innovation, and economic growth through unified cybersecurity practices integrated across all digital layers.

Source: <https://en.aletiyah.ae/news/uae/4664913/uae-cyber-security-council--palo-alto-networks-to-develop-ai>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-11

Palo Alto Networks Introduces Unified Human Identities in Cortex Cloud

Palo Alto Networks announced Unified Human Identities, a system-wide capability that connects disparate accounts (on-prem AD, identity providers, cloud roles, SaaS logins) to a single human identity using the user's email to reveal a person's full access footprint. The feature addresses fragmented identity risk, citing analysis that 99% of cloud users, roles, and services hold excessive permissions and many go unused for 60+ days. As AI tools and workflows expand exposure, the unified view enables security teams to assess true access risk at the human level, prioritize SOC alerts by identity, and improve privilege management across cloud, SaaS, and on-prem ecosystems.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/cloud-security/unified-human-identities-identity-risk-context/>

PARTNERSHIP**Cisco**

2026-05-11

Cisco AI Defense Integrates with Google Agent Development Kit for Runtime Agent Protection

Cisco announced an integration that extends Cisco AI Defense into Google's Agent Development Kit (ADK) and Agent Runtime to protect AI agents across their full execution path. The integration adds runtime controls for model calls, tool usage, and data boundaries without requiring developers to alter existing ADK workflows, preserving local protections through deployment on Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform. A quick-start `defend(agent, mode='enforce')` primitive secures local agents, and protected agents deploy through standard ADK flows. Two integration patterns—app-level plugin and agent-specific—address prompt influence on tool calls and data leakage at lifecycle boundary moments to enforce policy and monitor data flow.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/protecting-agents-with-cisco-ai-defense-and-google-agent-development-kit>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-05-11

Cisco Announces Foundry Security Spec for Agentic AI Security Evaluation

Cisco released the Foundry Security Spec on May 11, an open-source blueprint for building agentic security evaluation systems that is model- and stack-agnostic. The spec includes ~130 functional requirements, eight core agent roles, five extension roles, a finding lifecycle, and a coordination substrate, paired with a 'constitution' of eleven inviolable principles. Designed to integrate with GitHub's spec-kit, it aims to replace noisy, unverifiable alerts with verifiable security findings and scalable risk coverage. The framework emphasizes orchestration, guardrails, and a measurable 'done' signal driven by operator-defined coverage and economic yield thresholds, enabling defenders to respond faster and more effectively.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/announcing-foundry-security-spec>

RESEARCH**HiddenLayer**

2026-05-11

HiddenLayer Discloses Malicious Hugging Face Repo Impersonating OpenAI With 244K Downloads

HiddenLayer disclosed on May 11, 2026 a malicious AI supply-chain attack: a Hugging Face repository (Open-OSS/privacy-filter) masquerading as OpenAI's Privacy Filter was downloaded ~244,000 times in under 18 hours. The fake repo cloned the legitimate model's presentation and included a loader.py executing credential-stealing malware on Windows. The multi-stage chain disables SSL verification, fetches payloads via jsonkeeper.com, uses PowerShell with scheduled-task persistence, and installs a Rust-based infostealer targeting browsers, crypto wallets, and Discord. HiddenLayer identified six similar repositories using the same loader framework, underscoring AI model registries as growing software supply-chain attack vectors requiring strict provenance checks.

Source: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4169407/malicious-hugging-face-model-masquerading-as-openai-release-hits-244k-downloads.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS**

2026-05-11

AWS Launches Claude Platform on AWS and Bedrock AgentCore Payments

AWS announced general availability of Claude Platform on AWS on May 11, 2026, enabling AWS customers to access Anthropic's native Claude experience using AWS IAM authentication, AWS Marketplace consumption billing, and CloudTrail auditability, with rollout across multiple commercial regions. The Weekly Roundup also highlighted preview of Amazon Bedrock AgentCore payments, allowing AI agents to autonomously pay for APIs, MCP servers, and web content via Coinbase CDP or Stripe Privy wallets with session spending limits. GA of the AWS MCP Server and a preview of WorkSpaces for AI agents round out a broad push to make AI agents production-ready on AWS with managed governance.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-weekly-roundup-amazon-bedrock-agentcore-payments-agent-toolkit-for-aws-and-more-may-11-2026/>

PARTNERSHIP**Akamai**

2026-05-11

Akamai Signs \$1.8 Billion, Seven-Year Cloud Compute Deal with Anthropic

Akamai Technologies signed a seven-year, \$1.8 billion cloud compute agreement with Anthropic to support growing demand for Claude models—the largest deal in Akamai's history. The dedicated-capacity deal is expected to generate \$20-\$25M in Q4 revenue with much larger contribution in 2027, and Akamai plans \$700-\$800M in CapEx over the next year to support this single customer. AKAM stock jumped 26% on the news. Q1 results were solid (revenue +6% to \$1.01B; cloud infrastructure +40%; security +11%), and management positioned Akamai's distributed, edge-centric infrastructure as advantaged for low-latency AI inference workloads.

Source: <https://www.tikr.com/blog/akamai-nasdaq-akam-stock-jumps-on-1-8-billion-ai-deal-with-anthropic>

CORPORATE**Arista Networks**

2026-05-11

Arista Faces Persistent Supply-Chain Constraints Despite Strong Q1 AI Networking Demand

Arista Networks coverage on May 11, 2026 highlighted that despite Q1 earnings and revenue beating expectations, shares fell on supply-chain concerns. Management signaled industry-wide shortages in wafers, silicon chips, CPUs, optics, and memory will persist for 1-2 years, risking margins due to demand-supply imbalance. Arista is strengthening supplier relationships and entering multi-year purchase commitments to secure materials. The company raised 2026 revenue guidance to \$11.5B and lifted AI networking revenue target to \$3.5B. Solid enterprise demand and ongoing growth in cloud networking continue, driven by Arista's unified EOS/CloudVision stack and broad AI data-center product lineup including new XPO optics.

Source: <https://finance.yahoo.com/markets/stocks/articles/arista-tide-over-supply-chain-153100705.html>

LEADERSHIP**Fastly**

2026-05-11

Fastly Appoints Bruce Bennie as Area VP, Sales for Australia and New Zealand

Fastly announced on May 11, 2026 the appointment of Bruce Bennie as Area Vice President, Sales for Australia and New Zealand, based in Sydney. Bennie brings over 30 years of IT sales leadership experience, with prior senior roles at Juniper Networks, Infoblox, and Blue Coat Systems. He will oversee Fastly's ANZ growth, customer and partner relationships, and regional expansion across enterprise and public sector. The move aligns with Fastly's continued APAC and Japan investment in edge cloud, application security, and observability, and complements the recent launch of a partner certification program supporting low-latency, AI-ready infrastructure adoption.

Source: <https://itbrief.com.au/story/fastly-appoints-bruce-bennie-as-anz-sales-vice-president>

RESEARCH**Barracuda Networks**

2026-05-11

Barracuda Models AI-Driven Vulnerability Discovery Shift Toward Attackers Over Five Years

Barracuda Networks published a May 11, 2026 research briefing modeling how AI-driven vulnerability discovery will reshape risk over five years. Building on Anthropic Mythos findings, the model explores four scenarios with LLM capability at 60-80% and annual backlog discovery at 10-30%. The key projection: attackers will discover the majority of CVEs first, rising from roughly 1 in 3 today to 55-72% by year five. This reframes security strategy from 'finding flaws first' to 'remediating faster.' Recommended actions: increase vulnerability scanning frequency, automate patching by criticality, and reduce attack surface using zero-trust network access to stay ahead of AI-accelerated adversaries.

Source: <https://smbtech.au/news/barracuda-networks-models-how-ai-will-shift-vulnerability-discovery-toward-attackers-over-next-five-years/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Radware**

2026-05-11

Radware Introduces Alteon Protect to Deliver Scalable Application Security Without Compromise

Radware launched Alteon Protect on May 11, 2026, a scalable cloud-augmented security solution for application delivery controllers. The offering combines on-device enforcement on Alteon ADCs with Radware's cloud-based AI-driven protection to defend web apps and APIs against Layer-7 DDoS, API abuse, bots, and other web threats in real time. Key benefits include continuous security without SSL key sharing, no network redesign requirement, and scalable capacity via Global Elastic Licensing. Alteon Protect deploys on-premises or in the cloud, with options for direct deployments or Radware-managed services through MSSPs and MSPs—preserving performance and availability while expanding security scale for enterprises and service providers.

Source: <https://radware.com/newsevents/pressreleases/2026/radware-introduces-alteon-protect/>